

Tricia Ngoon, Ph.D

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Greater Good Studios
3759 W Diversey Ave
Chicago, IL 60647

Dear Hiring Manager:

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the **Human-Centered Design Lead** position with **Greater Good Studios**. With a Ph.D in Cognitive Science and 12 years of human-centered design research experience with a focus on educational technology, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to the Greater Good Studio's mission of advancing people-centered social change to combat inequities. I am confident that my skills in mixed-methods, human-centered design research, collaboration, and learning science uniquely position me for this role.

I have spent the majority of my career leading user-centered research initiatives towards equitable educational technologies. As a Postdoctoral Research Scientist, I envisioned, planned, managed, and delegated tasks throughout each phase of research projects for 3 educational technology tools. I worked with engineers, researchers, and designers to design, develop, and evaluate tools for teacher professional development in K12, higher education, and international contexts, serving over 400 teacher and student users. For my dedication to equitable education and technology, I was awarded a STEM Education Research Fellowship from the National Science Foundation. In my most recent role as a Research Scientist at TeachFX, I established the foundation for rigorous, data-driven user research. I interviewed over 50 K12 teachers and instructional leaders about their use and perception of AI tools in the classroom. In presenting findings to relevant stakeholders, I influenced key product decisions that led to a product rebrand with a new goal-setting feature for teachers. In addition, I collaborated across project teams and with external research partners, presenting to various relevant stakeholders and leading the writing of 4 grant deliverables to ensure timely compliance to grant obligations. Many of our research projects aimed to improve learning outcomes for learners from historically marginalized or low-income communities through improving automated speech recognition in the classroom. I believe my extensive experience in educational equity research and design research will be a significant asset to the Greater Good Studio team.

In addition to a strong research background in human-centered design, I also have great experience in teaching and mentoring. As a teaching assistant at the University of California, San Diego, I led teams of up to 10 other teaching assistants in effective design research pedagogy and feedback for over 10 academic quarters where I taught interaction design, introduction to design, and social computing. I was also appointed as Head Teaching Assistant for the Cognitive Science Department, where I worked with the university's Teaching and Learning Commons to develop workshops and trainings to prepare new teaching assistants for their duties and to aid in the transition of courses to online teaching during the COVID-19 pandemic. I helped mentor and train over 50 teaching assistants

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during my time in this role. Notably, I took the initiative to transform an Introduction to Design course to a flipped classroom format, leading to lasting changes that persist for the course today. Throughout my career, I have had the honor of mentoring promising undergraduate and graduate students in all aspects of human-centered design research from study design, participant recruitment, data collection, and data analysis. Of the 12 students I have mentored, 9 identified as women or people of color, and all have gone on to prestigious graduate programs or industry UX positions.

The mission of equitable education and technology drives my work. This position is perfectly aligned with my skills and career aspirations in user research, particularly in mission-driven organizations towards social impact. I am excited about the opportunity to bring my expertise and skills to Greater Good Studios. Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my experience and skills align with the needs of this role.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Tricia Ngoon', with a stylized flourish at the end.

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